

ENT, EYE, ENDOCRINE AND NERVOUS SYSTEM.

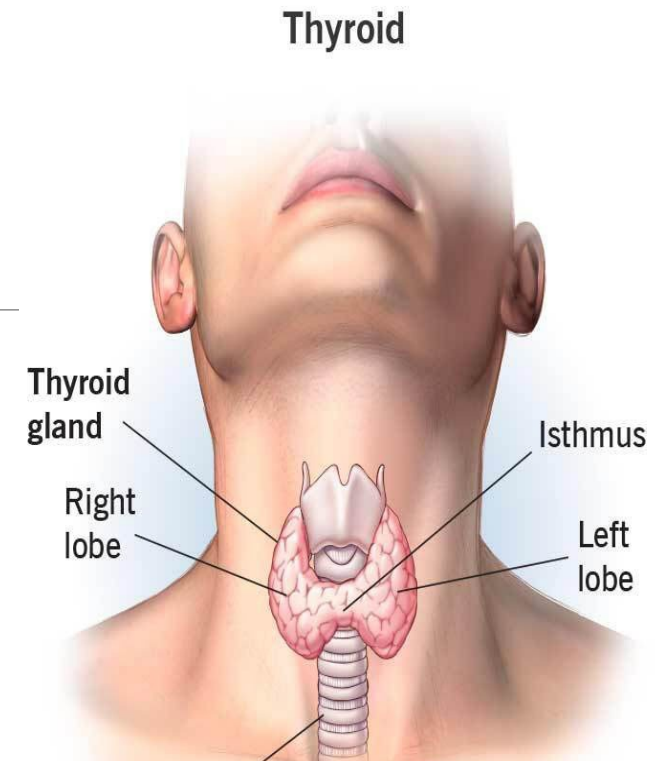
Series- 6

1. Thyroidectomy vs Para-thyroidectomy: (60210- 60500).

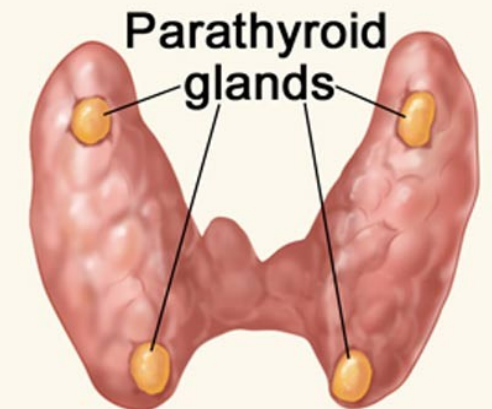
Thyroid gland: A butterfly-shaped endocrine gland located in the front of the neck that produces hormones (T3 and T4) to regulate the body's metabolism, growth, and other crucial functions, including heart rate, weight, digestion, and mood. Thyroid imbalance causes the hyperthyroidism (overactive) or hypothyroidism (underactive) respectively.

Para- thyroid gland: They are four small, **pea-sized** endocrine glands located in the neck, typically on the back of the thyroid gland. Their main function is to produce parathyroid hormone (PTH), which regulates calcium and phosphorus levels in the blood. Para thyroid imbalance causes the hyperparathyroidism (overactive) or hypoparathyroidism (underactive) respectively.

- ✓ Based on the **diagnosis (path report)** we have to code the thyroidectomy or Para-thyroidectomy.
- ✓ If the path report shown that the problem diagnosed in the parathyroid gland and there is no issue in the thyroid gland then we need to code only the Para thyroidectomy. No need to code the thyroidectomy because the thyroidectomy becomes the **incidental**.
- ✓ If the path report shown that the problem diagnosed in the thyroid gland and there is no issue in the parathyroid gland then we need to code only the thyroidectomy. No need to code the para -thyroidectomy because the para-thyroidectomy becomes the **incidental**.
- ✓ If both thyroid and parathyroid are diagnosed with the problem then both thyroidectomy and Para-thyroidectomy should be coded separately with the 59- modifier.



Thyroid gland (back view)



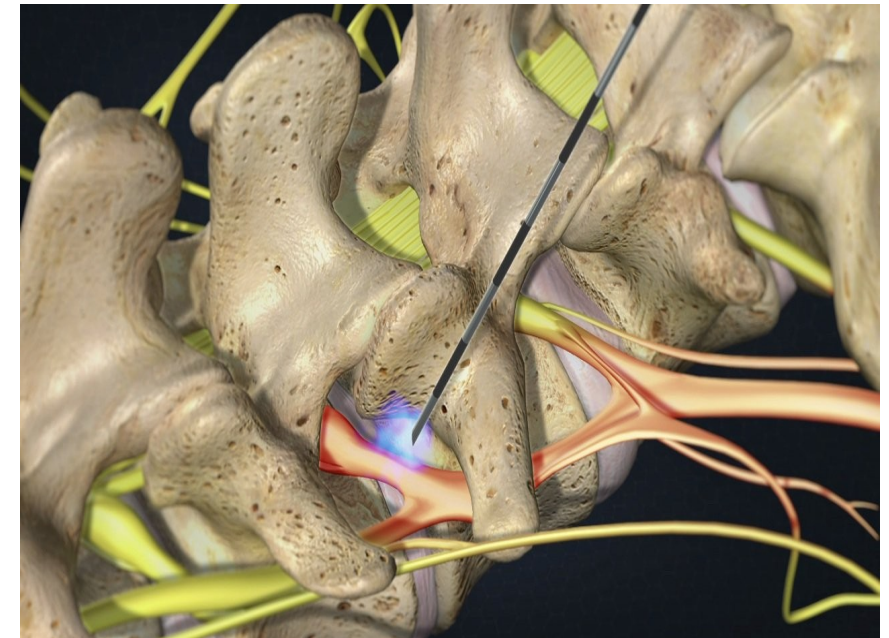
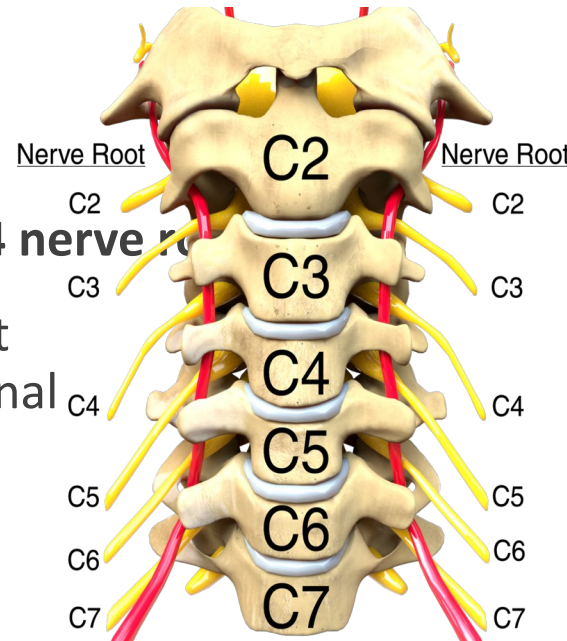
2. Nerve block injections (Anesthetic & steroid)

Nerve block is an injection of local anesthetic and/or anti-inflammatory medication near a targeted nerve or group of nerves to reduce inflammation and block pain signals. Used for both acute and chronic pain, blocks can be temporary, providing pain relief for hours to months, or longer-lasting, and are guided by imaging techniques like **X-ray or ultrasound**.

1. Transforaminal epidural steroid injection: (64479 - 64483).

A minimally invasive procedure where a corticosteroid and local anesthetic are injected into the **epidural space** through the neural foramen, or opening, where **spinal nerve roots** exit.

- The spinal nerve root are the nerve fiber bundles that comes off the spinal cord from each spinal segment. There are **4 nerve roots** per segment.
- Injection performed on the nerve root or epidural space by the transforaminal technique so it **doesn't** touch the **ligamentum flavum**.
- This include the **Flu/ CT guidance** so, no need to code separately.



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Single – Additional

1. Cervical/ Thoracic -

64479

-

+64480

2. Lumbar/ Sacral -

64483

-

+64484.

L1, L2, L3, L4 – **4 Levels.**

T1-T2; T3-T4; T4-T5 – **3 Levels.**

➤ RT/ LT/ 50 – Modifiers are applicable at each level, do not give 50-modifier to the **add on code.**

Ex-

➤ TSI was performed with the help of the fluoroscopy at the level of L1, L2, L3 - **64483, +64484 x2.**

➤ TSI was performed with the help of the fluoroscopy at the level of C1-C2, C3-C4, C5-C6 – **64479, +64480 x2.**

2. Facet joint/ Lateral joint/ Zygapophyseal joint/ Z- joint/ Medial branch block injection:

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There are 2 methods :

1. **Intra articular injections** – Injections that directly given to the facet joint.
2. **Medial branch block** – Injection of the **2 nerves** intervening each facet joint.

- ✓ This include the **Flu/ CT guidance** so, no need to code separately.
- ✓ **RT/ LT/ 50** – modifiers are applicable, do not give 50-modifier to the **add on code**.

First level - **2nd level** - **3rd/any additional level.**

1. **Cervical/ Thoracic** – **64490** - **+64491** - **+64492.**

2. **Lumbar/ Sacral** - **64493** - **+64494** - **+64495.**

Ex-

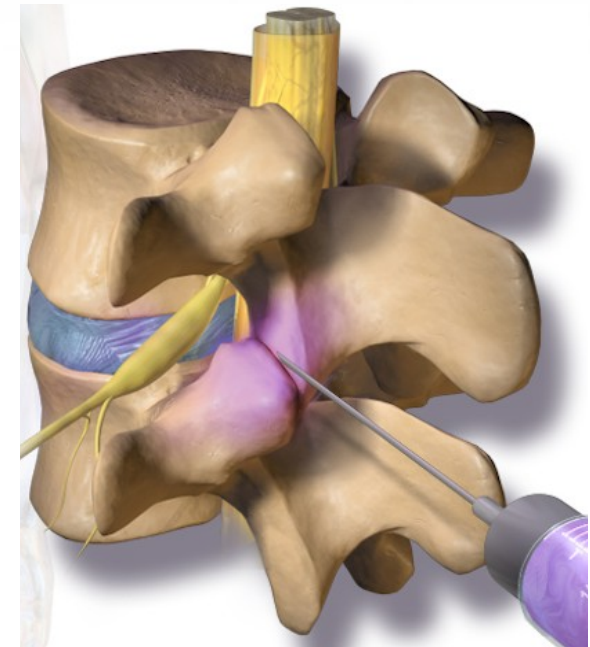
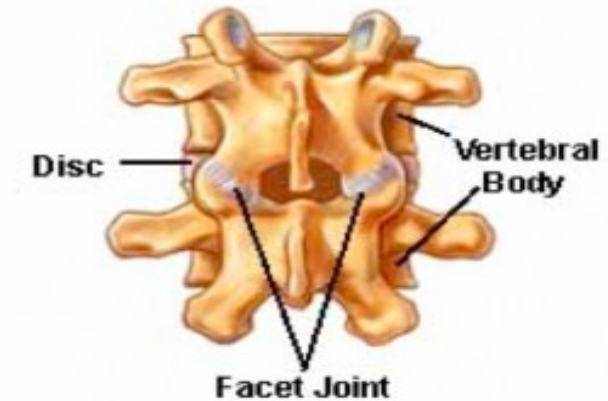
- PVB facet inj - L1, L2, L3, L4 - **CT. Guidance** - 64493, +64494, +64495.
- If performed **bilateral** PVB facet injection -

+64494 x2-RT, +64495 x2- LT.

64493 -50 ,

- If U.S guidance is used, then report the - **0216T – 0218T.**
- If image guidance is not used then code the **trigger point injections (20552-20553).**

Posterior Spinal Segment



3. Facet nerve destruction/ Radiofrequency ablation/ Rhizotomy :

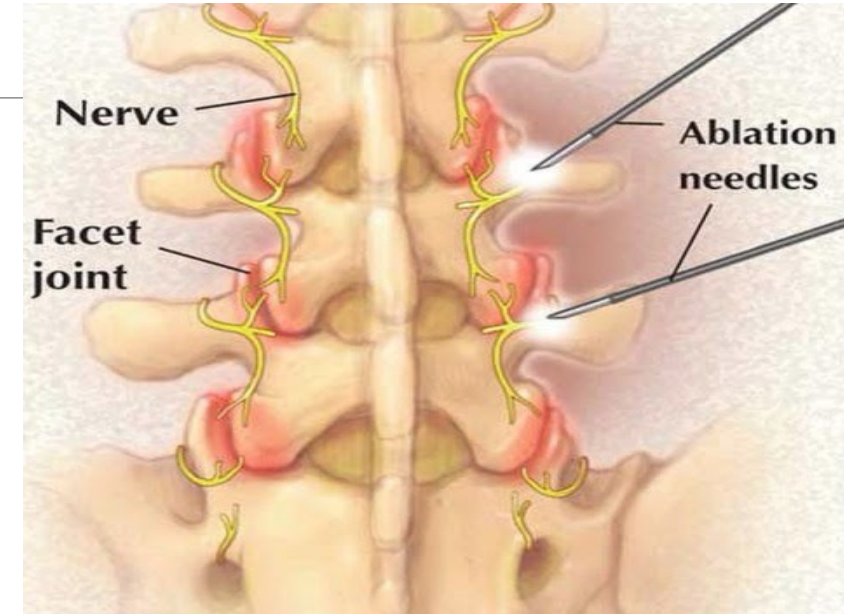
The destruction of the nerve root at 90degree Celsius temperature.

First level – **Each additional level**

1. **Cervical/ Thoracic** - **64633** - **+64634**

2. **Lumbar/ Sacral** - **64635** - **+64636**

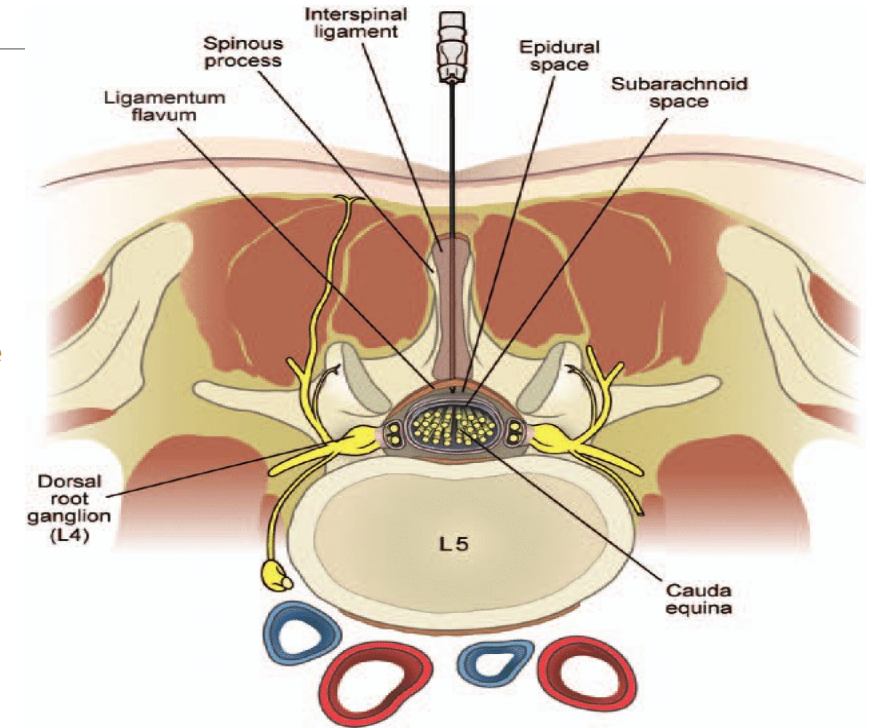
✓ This include the **Flu/ CT guidance** so, no need to code separately.



4. Interlaminar ESI :(62320- 62327)

- It is a Para median approach, procedure that involves the delivery of injection to the **epidural space** by directing a needle between the laminae of two adjacent vertebrae.
- Here the engagement of the **ligamentum flavum** takes place with LOS (loss of resistance).
- No laterality applicable (**No** RT, LT, 50- modifiers).
- Coding is based on the with/ without guidance.

	With image guidance	-	Without image guidance
1. Cervical/ Thoracic - (Inj) –	62321	-	62320
2. Lumbar/ Sacral - (Inj)-	62323	-	62322.
1. Cervical/ Thoracic - (Catheter)-	62325	-	62324
2. Lumbar/ Sacral - (Catheter) -	62327	-	62326.



5. Post operative pain control (analgesia)- (64400- 64450):

In order to control the pain after surgery the physician request the anesthesiologist to give the nerve block injection to control the pain.

- **Physician** - Coded with the procedure.
 - **Anesthesiologist**- Code with (64415-64450) based on the nerve got injection, with 59-modifier.
-

6. Laminectomy -

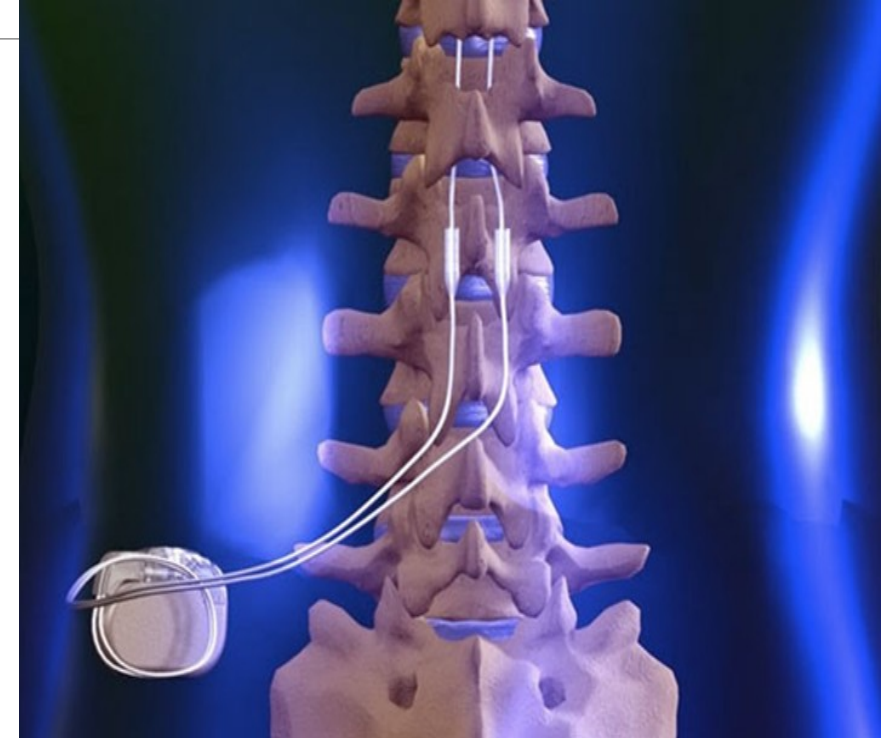
Surgical procedure that involves removing all or part of the lamina (the bony arch at the back of a vertebra) to enlarge the spinal canal and relieve pressure on the spinal cord or nerve roots.

- 63001- 63053
- 63265- 63287

7. Neuro stimulator :

Medical device, typically for chronic pain, that involves implanting a small pulse generator and thin electrical wires (leads) under the skin to deliver mild electrical pulses to the spinal cord or other nerves. This electrical stimulation interrupts pain signals from reaching the brain, providing pain relief without medication.

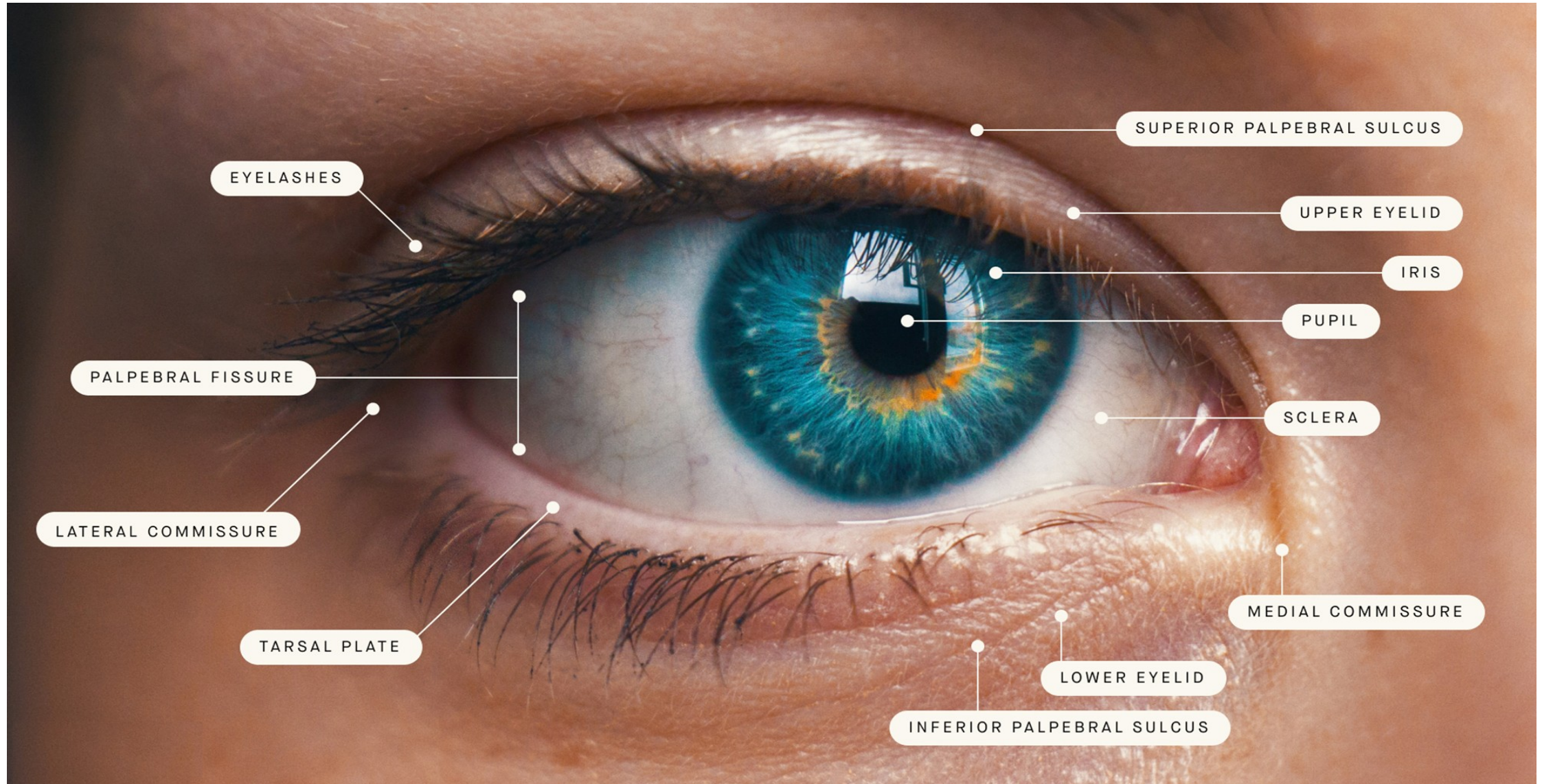
- Insertion of a percutaneous spinal electrode array for a spinal neurostimulator, commonly a temporary trial for spinal cord stimulation for chronic pain- **63650**.
- Laminectomy for the epidural implantation of a permanent spinal cord stimulator – **63655**.
- Insertion or replacement of a spinal neurostimulator pulse generator or receiver- **63685**.



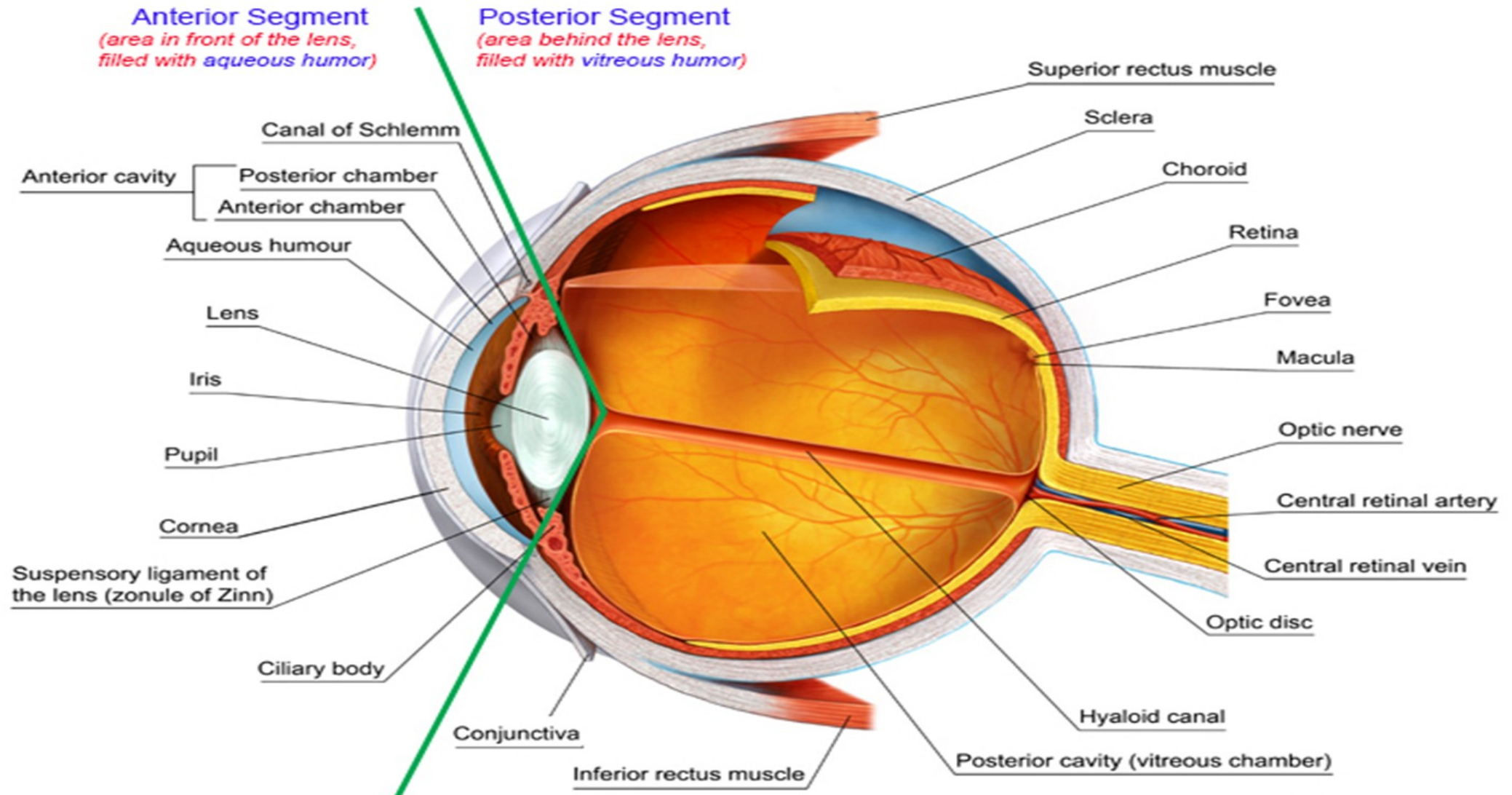
Doubts & discussion.....

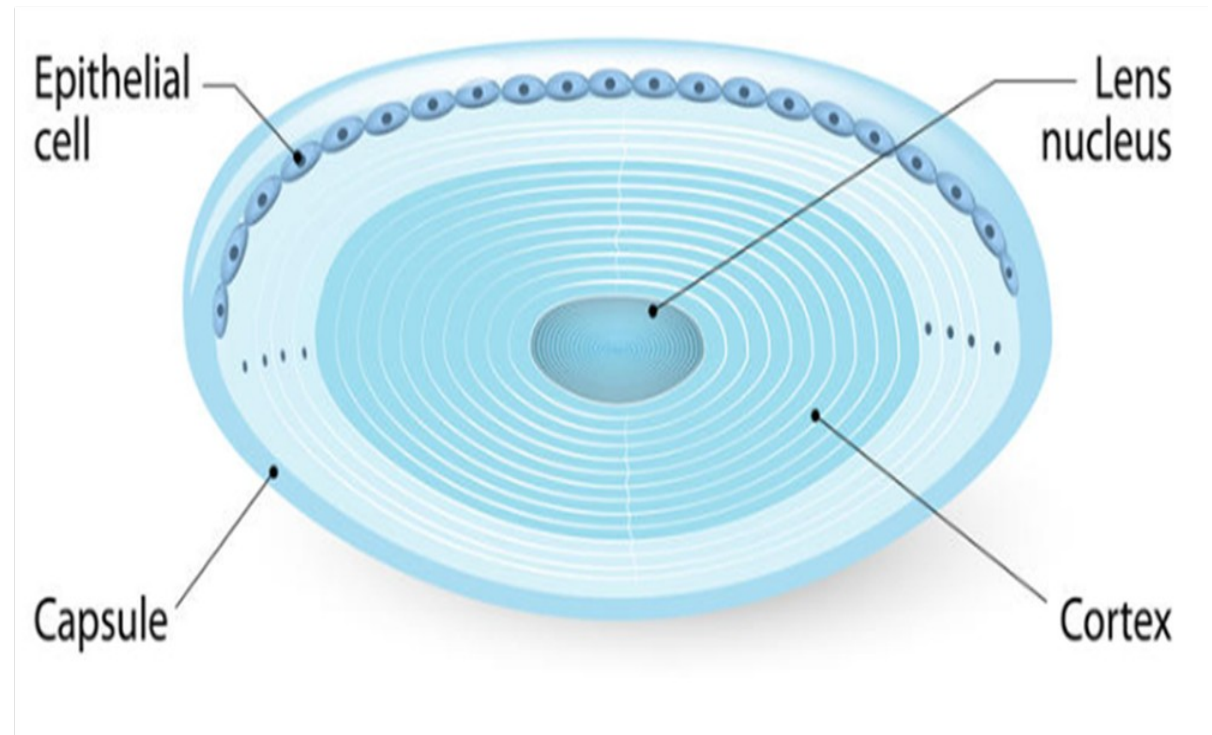
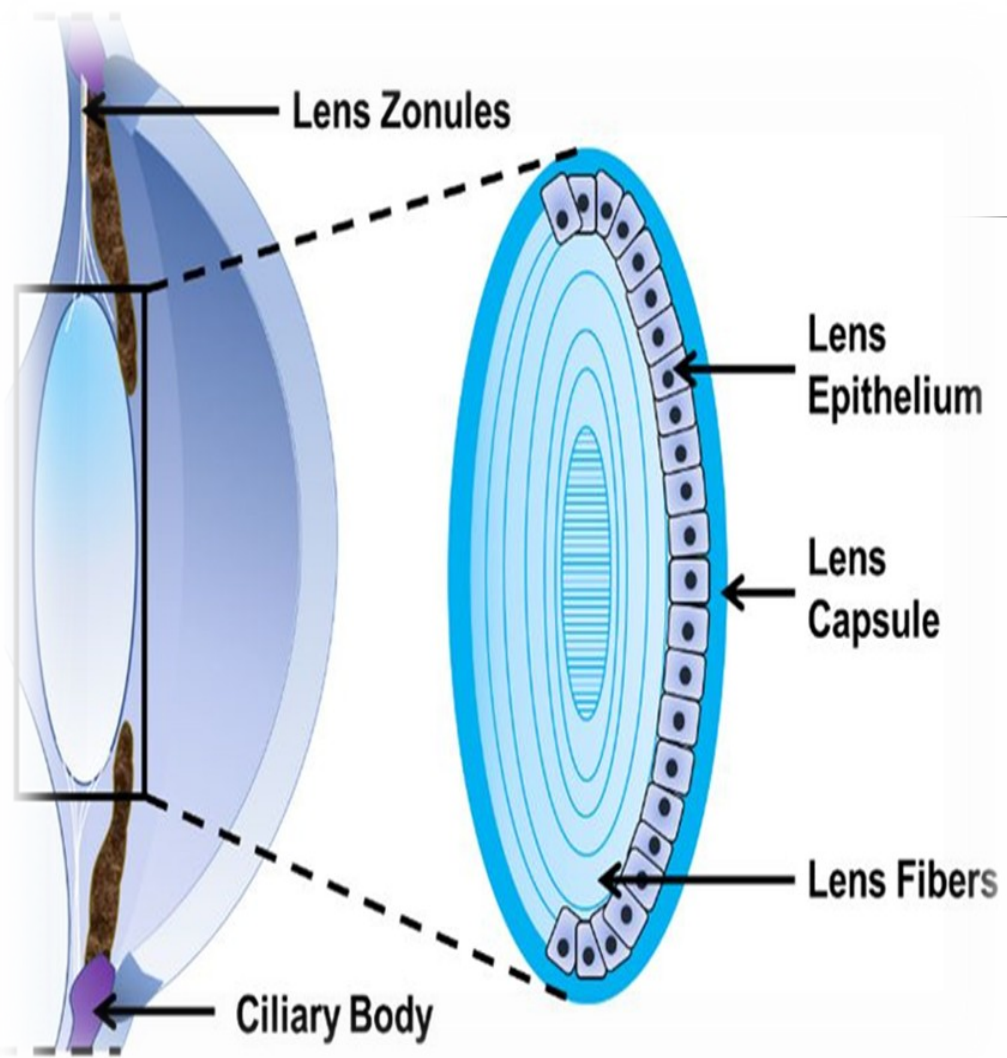


8. Eye procedures:

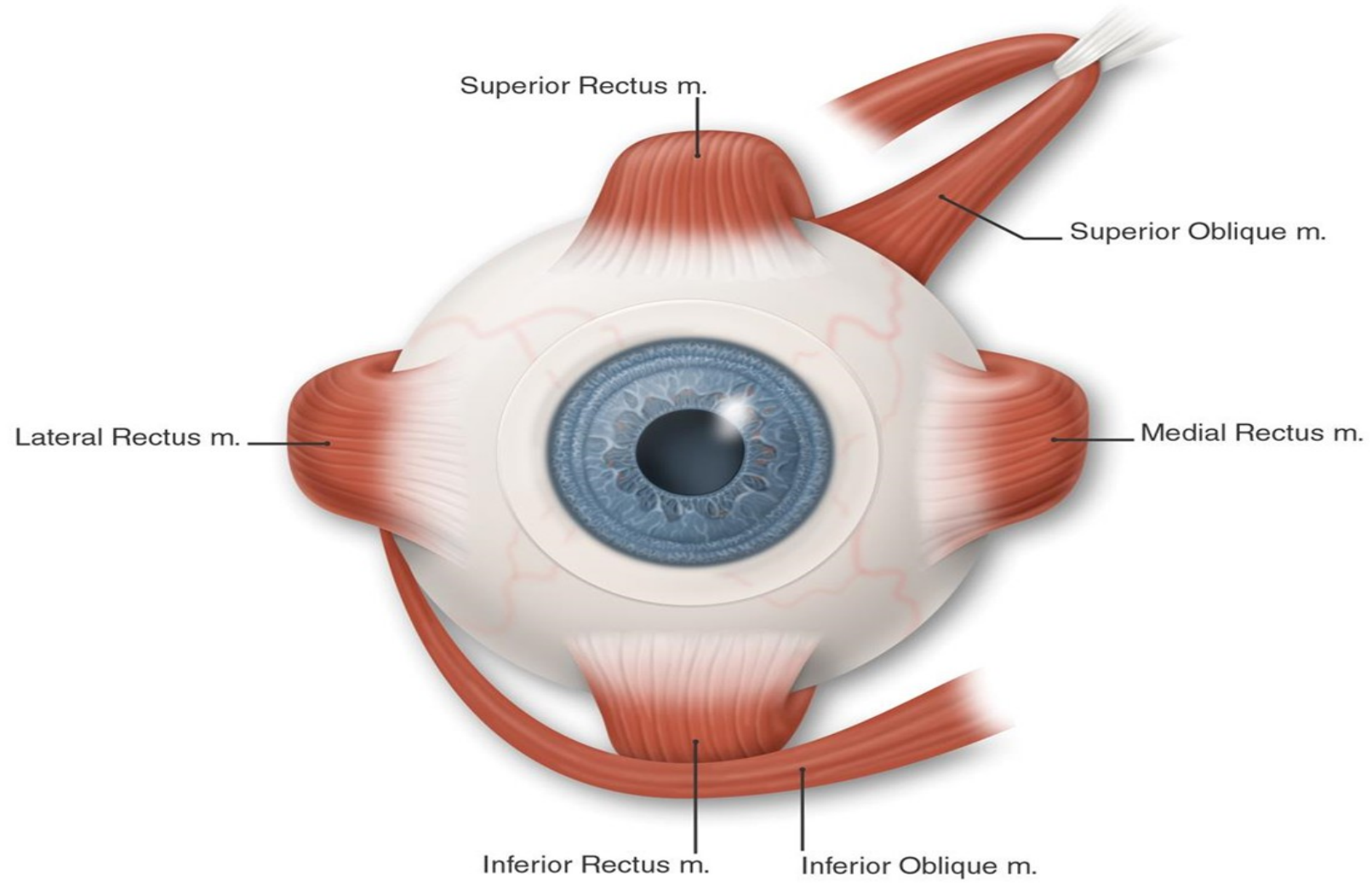


Internal eye:





Muscles of eye:



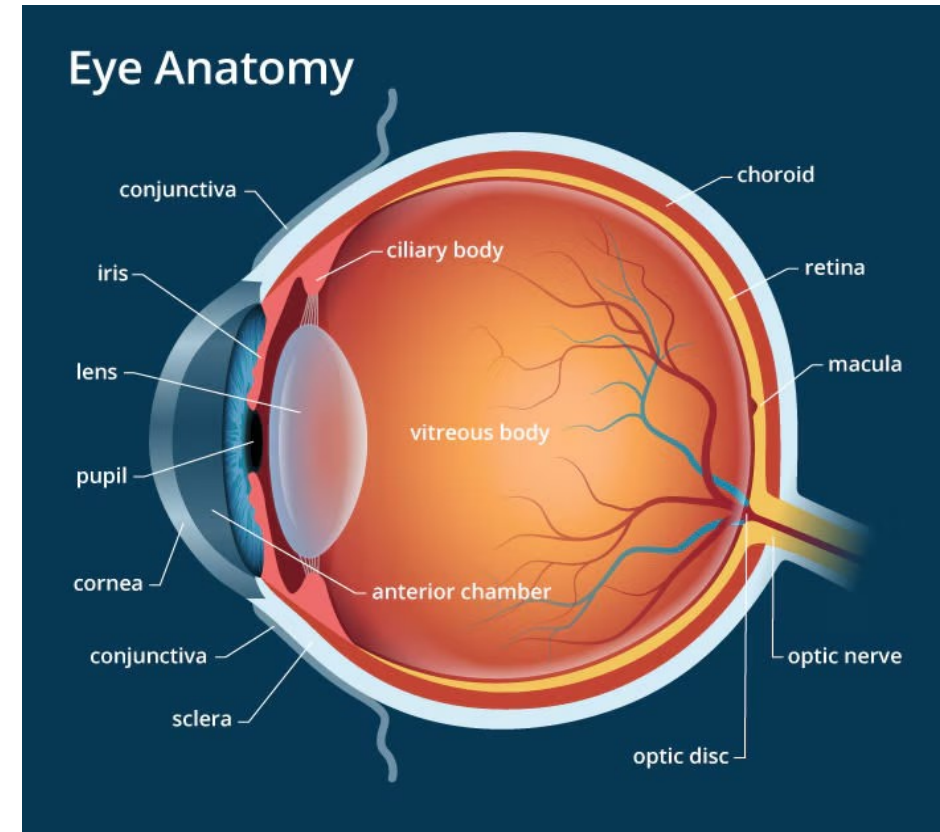
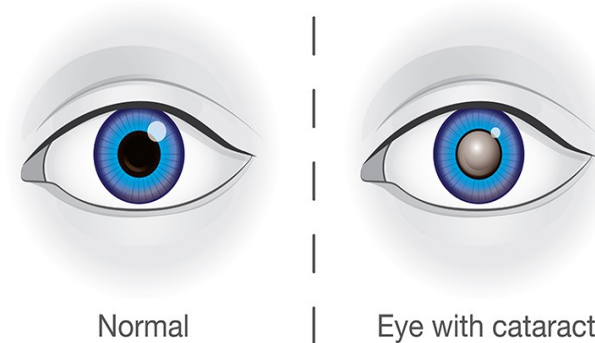
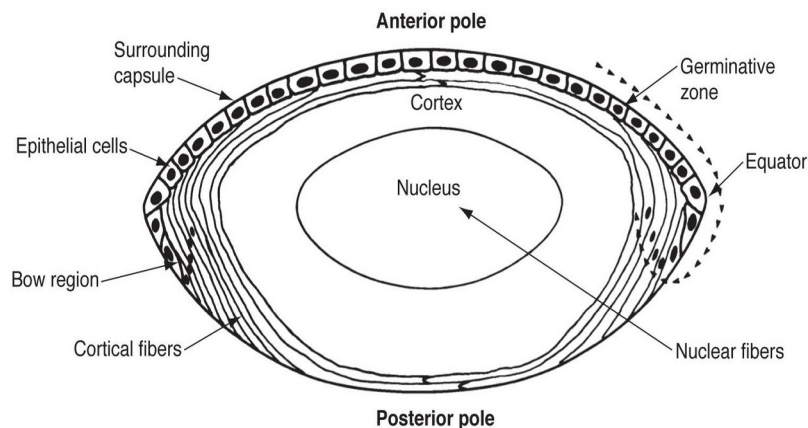
Cataract :

The clouding of the normally clear lens of the eye, which obscures vision. Symptoms include cloudy or blurry vision, faded colors, and increased sensitivity to light. While aging is the most common cause, other factors like diabetes, steroid medication use, and eye trauma can also contribute.

Treatment for a significant cataract involves surgical removal of the cloudy lens and its replacement with an artificial lens.

Types:

1. **Nuclear sclerotic cataract**
2. **Cortical cataract**
3. **Posterior sub capsular cataract.**



Cataract surgery type :

1. Extra capsular cataract extraction:- It is the method of the cataract surgery that involves removing the eyes natural lens while **leaving back the posterior capsule intact** to support an intraocular lens IOL in place. It requires the smaller incision compared to the ICCE.

➤ Simple ECCE :- 66984

1. Paracentesis- A small incision made on the iris to make the procedure.

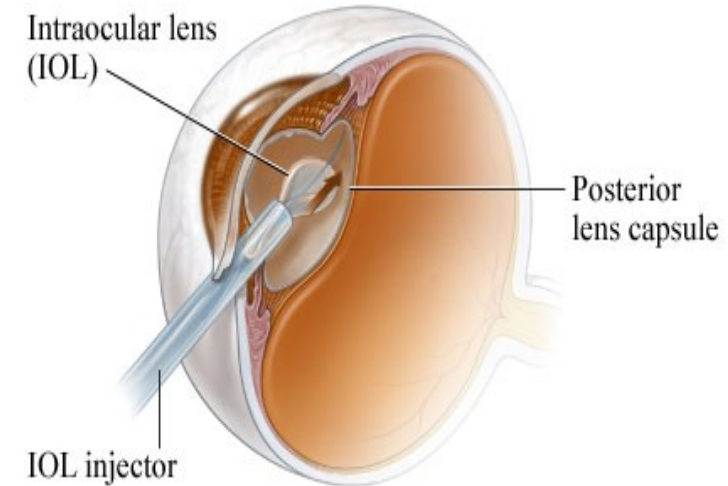
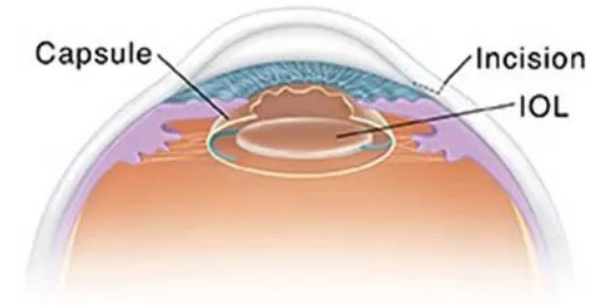
2. Capsulorhexis- Circular tear in the front anterior capsule of the eye's lens. This capsular window allows to access and remove the clouded natural lens (the cataract) and later implant an artificial intraocular lens (IOL).

3. Phacoemulsification- Using ultrasonic energy via a tiny probe to break up the cloudy natural lens into small pieces, which are then suctioned out. A new artificial intraocular lens (IOL) is then implanted, sealing the paracentesis port.

➤ **Complex ECCE:-** Required for dense, complicated cataracts that are too difficult to remove with standard methods. Uses advanced devices, special techniques, additional surgical steps- **66982**.

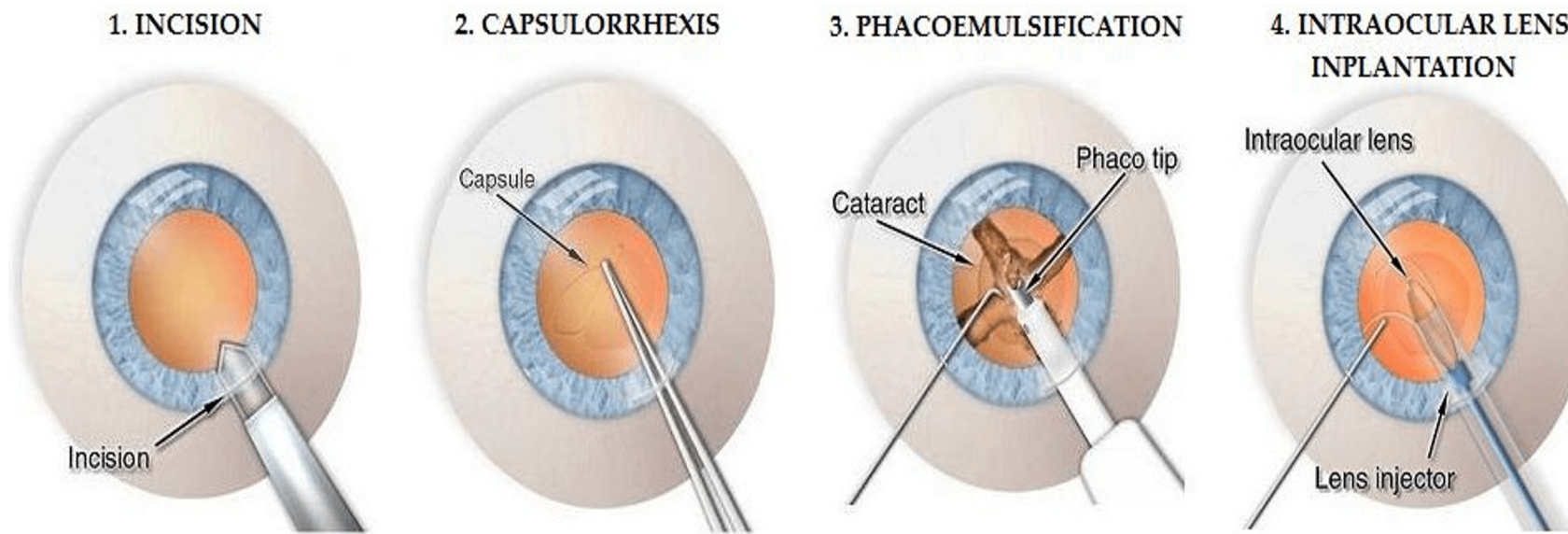
1. Iris expansion device. **2.** Mylene ring- Malyugin ring.

3. Methylene blue dye **4.** Suture support for IOL **5.** Posterior capsulorhexis.



2. Intra capsular cataract extraction : 66983

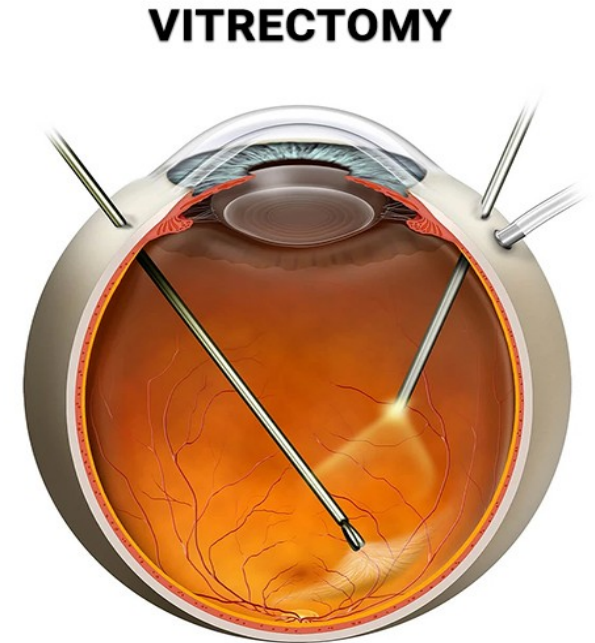
It is the method of the cataract surgery that involves removing the eyes natural lens along with the surrounding **posterior capsule** in one piece. It is relatively complex procedure compared to ECCE as it requires the larger incision compared to the **ECCE**.



9. Vitrectomy :

An eye surgery that involves removing the vitreous, a gel-like fluid that fills the back of the eye (space between lens & retina). The surgeon uses tiny instruments to cut and remove the vitreous, often replacing it with a saline solution, gas bubble, or silicone oil to maintain the eye's shape and support the retina during recovery. To treat retinal conditions like diabetic retinopathy, retinal detachment, vitreous hemorrhage.

1. Mechanical vitrectomy performed via a pars plana approach- **67036**.
2. Vitrectomy, mechanical, pars plana approach, **with removal of preretinal cellular membrane** (e.g., macular pucker)- **67041**.
3. Vitrectomy, mechanical, pars plana approach; **with removal of internal limiting membrane of retina** (repair of macular hole)- **67042**.
4. **Repair of a retinal detachment with vitrectomy**, including procedures like air or gas tamponade, endolaser photocoagulation, cryotherapy, drainage of sub retinal fluid, and/or scleral buckling- **67108**.
5. **Repair of a complex retinal detachment with vitrectomy** and membrane peeling- **67113**

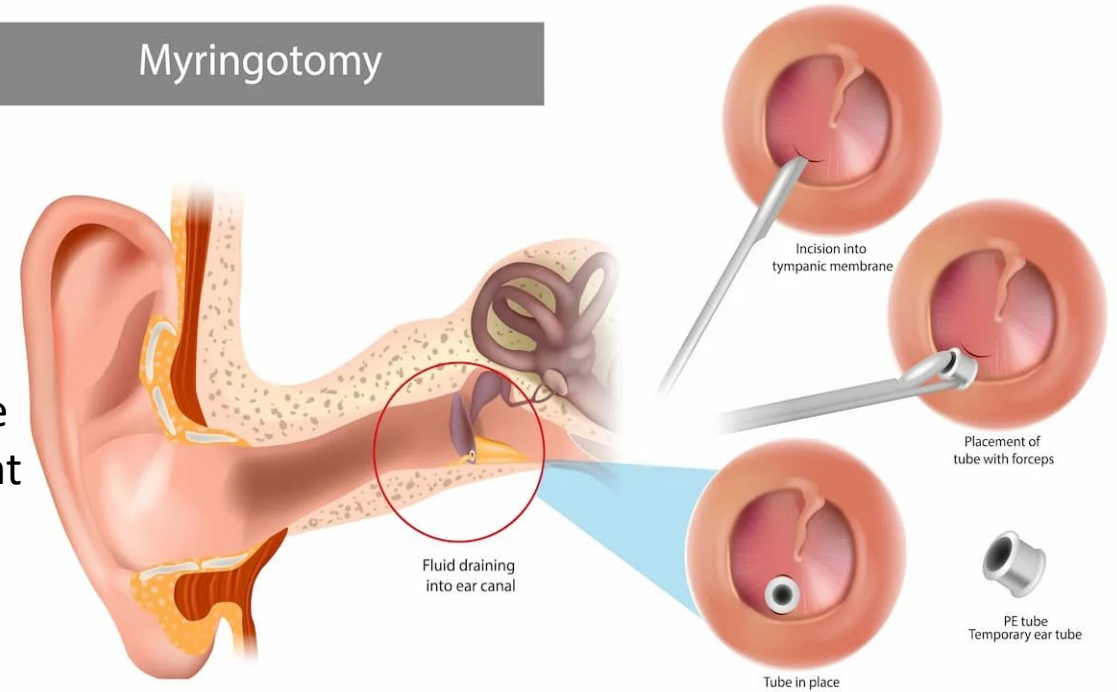


Myringotomy

10. Ear procedure – Tympanostomy :

A surgical procedure where small tubes, also known as ear tubes, are inserted into the eardrum to drain fluid and equalize pressure in the middle ear, helping to prevent or treat recurrent ear infections.

- **69433** - Tympanostomy with insertion of a ventilating tube using local or topical anesthesia.
- **69436** - Tympanostomy (requiring insertion of ventilating tube), general anesthesia.



Doubts & discussion.....



Interview question from 6-series:

1. Thyroidectomy vs Para-thyroidectomy ?
2. Nerve block injections ?

3. which nerve block injection involves the engagement of the ligamentum flavum ?
4. Neuro stimulator ?
5. Simple ECCE vs Complex ECCE?
6. Vitrectomy ?
7. Tympanostomy ?

Wish you Good luck....

